

K. ASIF

JEAN TOUBOUL
CEO, Pernod Ricard India

"The alcobev market is regulated all over the world, so we accept this regulation and the taxation that goes with it. India is complex, and this regulation, which is different in different states, does create difficulties"

VIVEK SAHNI
Co-founder & CEO, Kama Ayurveda

"Just give A-beauty a chance. We opened in the UK a year ago; we're at Harrods, and in Notting Hill. London has bad water and hard water and all their hair is falling out. So, they're using Bhringadi hair oil, and it's growing back"

RAHUL MISHRA
Designer

"Anything which is handmade, which is driven with purpose, driven with the idea of heritage, will become far more relevant in the time of AI, because things are going to be made far faster. So, power of hand is here to stay"

LANGUAGE OF LUXURY THE INDIA THREAD

AS THE NICER THINGS OF LIFE ALL POUR IN

With an annual growth rate of 30 per cent, India's luxury market that stands at $17 billion (Rs 1.48 lakh crore) is not just a gossamer dream woven in tall tales but a dynamic industry with global ambitions. With the turnover all set to triple by 2030, its remarkable transformation has been stoked by innovation, a precipitous increase in the number of HNIs (high net worth individuals) and disposable incomes, as well as a shift in consumer attitudes. However, its growth story is not just dominated by an expanding appetite for global brands, but also providing a fertile canvas for home-grown luxury brands to expand and experiment.

As India emerges as the next global luxury hub, Jean Touboul, CEO, Pernod Ricard India, one of the leading premium spirits brands in the world; Vivek Sahni, co-founder and chairman of Kama Ayurveda, a driving force in the homegrown beauty and wellness space; and Rahul Mishra, visionary fashion designer and the first Indian to showcase at the Paris Haute Couture Week, are perfect examples of India shining. If Pernod Ricard India's journey to becoming the largest alcohol player in the country by revenue is a mixed bag of rising premiumisation of spirits, elevated consumer tastes and growing disposable incomes, international fashion runways are mostly festooned with clothes that are more or less made in India. Whereas, in the beautyverse, it is the proliferation of A-beauty that has tickled imaginations across the globe. Kama Ayurveda has taken this idea of Ayurveda and made it available to urban Indians and, now, to a global audience with their stores in the UK. ■